Valeria Peshko

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Education

University of Helsinki, Doctor of Social Sciences 2019-2026

Thesis: "Enterprising Women in the Russian Empire"

Advisors: Jari Eloranta, Laura Ekholm
Pre-examiners: Selin Dilli (Utrecht University), Elena Korchmina (University of Bologna)
Opponent: Steven Nafziger (Williams College)

Defense date: 2.10.2026

European University at Saint Petersburg, Master *cum laude* in History of Art 2017

Employment

University of Helsinki, Department of Economic and Social History
Doctoral Researcher 2021-2025

Publications

Peer-reviewed Articles

"You Never Give Me Your Money: Barriers to Female Entrepreneurship in the Russian Empire, 1892-1914." (*forthcoming, European Review in Economic History*) DOI 10.1093/ereh/heag024

"Apprenticeships and Formal Business Schooling in Late Imperial Russia (1880–1917): A Gendered Perspective." *Essays in Economic and Business History (2024)* Available link.

Working Papers

"Who Owned Moscow? Gender Asset Gap in a 19th Century Metropolis."

Work in Progress (Selected)

"Urban Wealth Inequality in Revolutionary Russia: Protests, Ethnic Conflict and Voting." (with Tom Raster)

Other Publications

Review of Irina Potkina, *On the Eve of the Disaster. State and Economy of Russia in 1914-1917 [V preddverii katastrofy. Gosudarstvo i ekonomika Rossii v 1914 – 1917 godah]. Scandinavian Economic History Review (2022).* DOI 10.1080/03585522.2022.2121319.

"The Changing Status of Women and the Countryside in Early 20th-Century Russia." *Journal of the History of Ideas Blog (2021).* Available link.

"Not for Art's Sake: How Piotrovsky's Family Friends Built Their Business around the Hermitage." (with Proekt team, in Russian) *Proekt Media (2021).* Available link.

Seminars and Conference Presentations

2027: PSE Applied Economics Lunch Seminar (scheduled)

2026: LSE Graduate Seminar, Finnish Economic History Association Annual Meeting, WEast Belgrade, UHILL Mini-workshop, Workshop on Nordic and Baltic political and economic inequality c. 1400–1900 (Uppsala University)

2025: 10th European Review of Economic History Review Fast Track Meeting, World Economic History Congress, University of Helsinki Economic & Social History Seminar, Uppsala Center for Business History Seminar, Uppsala History of Inequality and Labor Lab Workshop, Annual Workshop of the Economic History Society Women's Committee

2024: University of Gothenburg Higher Seminar in Economic History, Democracy and Development Workshop (University of Helsinki), Baltic Connections Conference

2023: YSI-EBHS Doctoral Workshop, Economic and Business History Society Conference, Summer Workshop in the Economic History and Historical Political Economy of Eurasia, Baltic Connections Conference, University of Jyväskylä Economic History Seminar

2022: Economic and Business History Society Conference (Remote), Gustav Vasa Seminar, University of Tübingen Business History Summer School

2021: Social Science History Association Annual Meeting (Remote), Baltic Connections Conference (Remote)

2020: European Business History Association Summer School (Remote)

2019: Annual Conference for the Doctoral Programme in Social Sciences & the Doctoral Programme in Political, Societal and Regional Change

Research Visits

Uppsala University
Hosts: Tom Petersson and Jakob Molinder — Sep-Oct 2025

Fellowships, Honors and Awards

External

Emil Aaltosen Säätiö (Emil Aaltonen Foundation, 5th year funding), 2025, 21,825 €

Oskar Öflunds Stiftelse (Oskar Öflund Foundation), 2025, 1,000 €

Kulturfonden för Sverige och Finlands (Swedish-Finnish Cultural Foundation), 2025, 1,250 €

University of Helsinki

Travel grant, Naistutkimuksen tuki-rahasto (Women's Studies Support Fund), 2025, 1,050 €

Travel grant, University of Helsinki Doctoral School, 27.07-01.08.2025, 1,000 €

Travel grant, Naistutkimuksen tuki-rahasto (Women's Studies Support Fund), 23-25.05.2023, 700 €

Writing retreat, University of Helsinki Doctoral School, 1-4.12.2021, 260 €

Travel grant, University of Helsinki Doctoral School, 26-27.03.2020, 350 € (Not used)

Teaching

University of Helsinki

YK-211: Global Economic Change 2022 (with Jari Eloranta)

YK-211: Global Economic Change 2023, 2024, 2025 (with Andrei Markevich)

Other Professional Activities

Referee

Scandinavian Economic History Review, European Review of Economic History

Conferences & Sessions Organized

Session Co-organizer, "Female Entrepreneurship in the Long 19th Century from the Global Perspective", World Economic History Congress, July 2025

Workshop Co-organizer, Speaker, "Leveraging AI for Historical Data Digitization", Department of Economic and Social History, University of Helsinki, April 2025

Session Co-organizer, "Less barriers, greater opportunities? Women in business in Northeastern Europe, 1800-1900", Economic and Business History Society Conference, May 2023

Organizing Committee Member, 8th Annual Conference for the Doctoral Programme in SS & PSRC, October 2021

Other Activities

Volunteer, Economic and Business History Society Conference, May 2021

Volunteer, Baltic Connections Conference, April 2021

Other Work Experience

Hermitage Museum, Department of Western Art
Research Assistant 2018-2019

Skills

Languages: Russian (Native), English (Fluent), Finnish (Advanced), German (Reading level), French (Reading level)

IT: R, Python, Stata, QGIS